

OREGON CITY ENTERPRISE

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WEEKLY SOLDIER LETTER

The following letter has been received by Mr. and Mrs. J. E. Hedges from their son, Joseph Hedges, Jr., written in Paris, France:

Paris, France, April 8, 1919.

"Dear Father and Mother:

"At last after much delay, the postal service seems to have located me again. Yesterday I received six letters and one postal card, the first mail since my arrival in Paris. Five of them were from you and Dorothy, numbers 25, 29, 30, 35 and 42. I had already received letters No. 33 and 37 over a month ago at Mehus, so you can see how erratic the mail is and also what letters are still missing. One letter from Father dated January 19 and a post card dated March 3, also came yesterday. Evidently there is still a good deal of mail on the way.

"Since writing last I have had a pleasant surprise. About a week ago I was coming out of the American library and ran into Ben Harding. Was certainly surprised to see him. We had a mighty interesting talk about our respective experiences during the last year and a half. He is also here taking work at the University of Paris. We have located a double room on the Boulevard de la Chapelle, and I expect to move in with him within a few days. I rather dislike to leave my present place as the people are mighty nice and I have the advantage of daily practice in conversational French. On the other hand it is really too far from the University, being almost directly across the city and it makes me hustle to get to an 8:30 class on time. Another consideration is that from now on the students can obtain 48-hour passes out of the city for week-end trips. Ben and I are planning several trips east to some of the important points along the old front, including Rheims, Soissons, Chateau-Thierry, Amiens, et al. Therefore, it will be much more economical in the long run I think.

"Saturday before last I saw the 89th Division play the 36th Division for the football championship of the A. E. F. The former won by a score of 14 to 8. About 25,000 soldiers witnessed the game. Several special trains had come down from Germany bringing men from the Army of Occupation to see the game. After the game General Pershing congratulated the winning team while they were still on the field. The enthusiasm and spirit displayed throughout the game by the spectators reminded me of a good deal of the university games at home.

"The same evening I went to the opera 'Faust' with Lieutenant Catterson. The voices were all very fine and I enjoyed it very much, although grand opera is a little too heavy for me to appreciate to the full extent. The opportunity of seeing the interior of the building itself I appreciated more I think. It is truly a wonderful structure. The elaborate foyer and grand staircase of Byzantine marble, the elaborate and harmoniously decorated interior of the theatre proper and the enormous stage are all past description.

"My progress in the language seems rather slow, but nevertheless I am improving. The fact that the rate of progress in learning a foreign language is an accelerating one is encouraging at any rate. It is always the beginning that is difficult. Next week is Easter vacation for the French students, but I understand there are to be special lectures for the American students besides an examination in each course covering the work to date.

"Well, I must close. Will write again soon.

"Love to all.

"Your son,

"JOE."

Sorbonne Detachment, A. P. O. 702.

Mr. and Mrs. H. W. Creason of 17th Street, Oregon City, are in receipt of an interesting letter from their son, Henry H. Creason, which was written March 30, before sailing for home. He arrived in New York from France April 24, and is now stationed at Camp Mills. He will start for Camp Lewis about May 10.

Henry Creason saw some of the heaviest fighting in the Argonne Woods, but did not receive any wounds. His parents reside at Oregon City, and his wife and her parents, Mr. and Mrs. W. E. Bonney, reside at Colton.

The following is the letter received:

"March 30, 1919.

"My dear Mother and Father:

"Sunday night and I am still at the rifle range near Lakewood, but think we will go back to Bouere in a day or two.

"I suppose you have seen in the papers where the 7th Division starts for the states. It sure will be soon now, I hope, but I have almost given up hopes of ever starting.

"For a wonder, the sun is shining this evening, and it sure does look good. The ground was covered with snow this morning, and it was cold. I would like to know when they have good weather over here. It does beat any place I have ever been.

"We hiked to Laseux yesterday to have a bath—sure some walk to take a bath, but it was worth it, and was the best bath I have had in France. I can't think of a darn thing to write. I never get to see anything

new or go any place, so there isn't much to write about.

"It sure is fine that Aunt Kate has come to visit you at last. You ought to keep her with you until I return home, and we will all go to California together.

"I have sent some souvenirs to you, and wonder if you have ever received them. They have all kinds of things like that over here now, but most of them are priced too high for one to buy, and suppose they have lots of the same stuff at home. I sure don't want anything like that myself after I get home, for I have seen enough to last me the rest of my life without any souvenirs.

"I guess there are great places and wonderful things to see in France, but I don't expect to see any of them, and what I have seen, it is nothing what I thought it was.

"This place here is almost like it is at home, only so much more rain, and the soil doesn't look as good. I haven't seen any crops or anything growing that looks as good as old Oregon yet.

"I have just finished supper and it was a kind of surprise for we had 'gold fish' or salmon and spuds, bread and coffee. The salmon had onions cooked with it. Oh, yes, we had a pickle, too. It sure was an unusual supper for over here.

"Monday morning, the last day of March, and am still in France. I did not get to finish this last night. We have heard more rumors about starting home, and the last one is that we sail the 10th, but I won't believe we are going until we are on the boat. We hear that we are going to get big boats. I hope we do, as the one we came over on was awful, and had been used as a cattle boat and it was sure hell. I don't think I ever got as hungry before in my life as I did then for the food they gave us was not fit to eat, and had to partake of spoiled meat and soup. I don't think I will get sick going back, for I didn't come over, and the eats should be better too.

"I hear that we will get another 'shot' before starting to prevent 'flu'. I don't think there is any more of it over here now, haven't heard of any cases lately. They had it awful in England for a while.

"I hate to think of train trips over there, but it is better than it was when we first got here, for we have straw in the cars now. At first we were loaded so many in a car that there wasn't even room for all to sit down at the same time.

"It sure will be a great trip across the states this time of the year. I can imagine just how a good berth will feel and it will certainly be a change from where we used to be.

"I would like to know what kind of clothes we will get to go home in. If we don't get better than we have now, I sure won't wear them home if I can help it. I have heard that some of the men have gone home in awful clothes.

"Well, the fellow that sleeps next to me just asked me who I was writing to, and I told him my mother, and he said tell her that he was going to write to her also, and that he was going to tell how I got blew up, but didn't get hit. We were in a funk hole, together at one time, and swapped addresses. The shells were coming fast and thick, and we thought our time might come next. His name is Jerry Cullen, and his home is in Wisconsin.

"Well, I can't think of anything more to write, and hope that everyone at home is well, and hope to see you all soon. I will let you know as soon as I land in the states.

"All my love for everyone at home.

"Your loving son,

"H. H. CREASON,

"Company A, 365th Infantry.

"A. E. F. France.

"P. S.—I hope I will be in the states before I can get an answer to this letter."

Mr. and Mrs. John Boss of Oregon City, Route 2, are in receipt of a letter from their son, Private John Boss of Company E, 62d Infantry, now stationed at Camp Lee, Va.

He writes:

"Dear Folks:

"I'll write you a letter tonight to let you know I'm well. The weather here has been rather cool for this time of the year.

"Yesterday another fellow and I took a little trip to the place they call 'The Crater.' This is where Generals Grant and Lee fought in the Civil War. There is still some of the tunnel left that Grant's troops dug to get under Lee's fortifications to blow them up. There is also some of the embankment that Lee's men used for fortifications.

"I went all through the museum where they keep all kinds of old relics of the Civil War. They had queer-looking old rifles and bayonets, and cannon balls. I also saw Confederate money. Five, ten, fifteen, twenty-five cent pieces and so on up all in paper money. It was sure interesting and believe me I took it all in while I was at it.

"They changed our officers again. They are pretty good to us fellows too. I have always had good officers.

"We are getting extra good food now. Haven't had Virginia beefsteak all week. The mess sergeant is some 'guy', believe me. He always says that us fellows get enough to eat. The French cook left a little while back and we weren't sorry at all.

That fellow couldn't even boil coffee without burning it.

"The people here in Virginia don't think much of us 'Western Boys'. They think we are an awful tough bunch. When we go to Petersburg and happen to tell anybody that we came from 'The West' they jump clear off the street. Oh, well, we always get a clear street that way anyway.

"I don't know when I'll get to come home. I have an idea it won't be very soon.

"Well, goodbye.

"From

"JOHN."

The following interesting letter has been received from Roy Stafford, who is with the Eighteenth Engineers, written shortly before leaving for the United States. Mr. Stafford is the son of Mr. and Mrs. W. B. Stafford, of Mount Pleasant:

March 27, 1919.

"Dear Folks:

"As this will be more descriptive than personal I'll include mother and all the rest. We were notified about 6 P. M. of the 18th, inst., that our 3-day passes for Lille had been granted and dated that day. So I said let us go at once.

"The Paris Express left at 10 P. M. G. O. says take your pack. Very annoying indeed. But orders don't bother. It is the possibility of detection in the army that counts.

"Four of us were going as far as Paris. So we walked the 2 miles to the train and went into Bordeaux. Here we checked our packs with the 'Y'. Hustled to the depot, checked out, bought ticket, 2d class, 13fs, and found a seat. Went into the A. R. C. for coffee, but the crowd was too big for us to wait.

"Things started right out. The train was full and more. Next to me in the compartment was a fair young woman, the wife of the one-eyed ex-soldier opposite. Corner seats being very desirable, I closed the light and was soon doing just what might be expected from a kitten on a cold night. She pulled a fur round her neck and I cushioned my face thereon and 'couch shyed' like as if I owned the whole layout.

"Morning found us very hungry so when they hooked on a restaurant car we landed right into it along with the notables. There was a choice of coffee or cocoa, bread and butter, cost \$1.50 or 2 fs, very reasonable.

"Got into Paris at 9:30 A. M. Checked in and were told to get out at 11:55 A. M. Well I did not intend to do that. So we went up to M. P. headquarters. Here they told us the train left at 1:30 P. M. and we must take it. At the information desk down stairs they said the train left at 12:25 P. M. They all said the same depot. We were very hungry so decided to eat and incidentally to miss that train. Had a good meal for 6fs, and got to the depot at 1 P. M. feeling sure the train had gone at 12:25 and it had.

"They did not beef at all but gave us a pass till 8 P. M. that night.

"We lit out at once for Versailles. Of course we did not have any pass for there but we must see it if possible. On the way we took a look at the 'Pantheon le Guerre'. And a 'Y' man showed us a car for Versailles. Got there a bit late but saw the 'Chateau' and all of the paintings and the beautiful grounds. They are all that is said about them. I had a hard time coaxing the boys to follow a crowd of sightseers whom I felt sure were going to see something of interest. And we soon found ourselves in the ancient tennis court where the constitution of France was first brought about.

"We soon arrived in Paris, went to the Palace of glass and lost one of the party somehow. I was very sick from the effects of the stuffy car the night before. So after showing the boys a good restaurant I perched myself on the Republic statue and shivered while they ate. It wouldn't come up for me so I had to stay sick till morning.

"We got our tickets and checked out, 9 fs, 3rd for 1.10. Found our lost one and the fourth had left us for he was off for London to see people of his.

"A frog captain was already in, and in the corner opposite lay a Frenchman's coat. I moved it and feigned sleep. The frog came in soon after and wanted the seat. I told him I was sick and the sergeant with me also told him in good French. He was very angry, so was I, and he appealed to captain as he was only a sergeant. Well we were three and bluffed them out. As a coat can't hold a seat when I want one that bad.

"It was very cold and uncomfortable. Morning found the ground covered with wet snow. And shell holes everywhere. Armenieres was the first place of any size which we saw. It is a dismal wreck. From that on it was all trenches and ruins and craters. We arrived in Lille at 9 A. M. and found a jackie in a 'white' waiting to take us up town. That was fine. Soon we were gazing at the ruins of 1914 and looking for a restaurant as the city is running in good shape now that the Germans have retired.

"We found one and ate some of our own rolls to help out. The M. P.'s were minus and we were told that it was no trick at all to go to Brussels. Well, I knew that Bill Strohmeier was up there and intending to go over so we said 'we'll try it.'

"Lille was very interesting although it was raining. We checked in and went sight seeing. The British are everywhere from now on. We saw the great old walls and climbed the church tower and ate at the 'Salvation Army, 150f for an excellent meal. The boys all speak well of the Salvation Army.

"At 4 P. M. we were on the train again. And clear into Brussels where we could see the broken rails where the Huns had shot out every one, did not miss a thing. Here too we began to see the pillaged factories that are scattered along the entire railway and canal, the whole trip to Belgium.

"We arrived at 9 P. M. after many delays meeting several British trains bound for demobilization centers.

"Well, Brussels looks fine; all

Highways and Byways

Harvey Cross occasionally hits the nail on the head. He uttered a truth Tuesday night when he said most of the people of Clackamas county would be dead before the main roads were paved at the rate we are now going with one paving plant.

Five paving plants in Clackamas county to do five times the present paving mileage each year, urged Mr. Cross.

We like a man with a vision.

The Enterprise pioneered for hard surfaced roads in Clackamas county when the plan was none too popular. In a few short years we have seen the whole county shouting for permanent roads and more of them.

What's the answer?

Before the end of 1920 the Pacific highway will be paved from one end of Clackamas county to the other, and two roads between Oregon City and Portland on the east side of the Willamette will be hard surfaced, besides the road to Baker's bridge and other short stretches. These improvements will satisfy the motorists who run through the county, but they will not satisfy the people who live in every section of the county and who are entitled to receive a share of the good roads as long as they are willing to stand up and fight for them and as long as they are willing to pay for them.

The time is rapidly approaching in Clackamas county when an enlargement of road program will be demanded and insisted upon by the farmers themselves. Speed the day.

that it had been described. No M. P.'s. Well now!

"We quickly secured a room with two beds, for 12fs. Then we started on a tour of inspection as you see our time was very limited. Well, we soon began to see it on all sides. The streets are very wide and the stores fine. The cafes were very fine and all full. So we had a stein of really good beer. And rubbed elbows awhile and then dropped in another. Here a real orchestra held forth, and beer only 50 centimes a stein. The people looked happy and were spending their money as if they had lots more.

"Well this looked good to us and we went further. Found the street of cabarets and it was just like a carnival. British of all makes, women galore. A few Americans and lots of civilians.

"We stayed till closing time, 12 P. M. When we arrived at our hotel we found there were two exactly alike. One was still open so I said it must be this one and blew in. Well I was the long lost son. A girl had me in her arms before I could get my hands out of my overcoat, saying 'I love you', and I guess that she did. The other fellows saw me through the

door and when they entered they were swarmed upon by two other girls. Well we mentioned our room, but they did not know anything about it. The place was the twin of the other hotel and we couldn't quite make it all out. It was too funny for words. Finally we knew that they were just entertaining us so that we would stay and buy drinks. Well we departed and found our own place. Here there were two very sociable girls that made love to all of the customers. Not bad kids either.

"Next morning we had breakfast nearby and indiscreetly ordered chocolate. It cost 3c per cup. Our fun then began. Took in an old castle, full of all kinds of old war material, then saw the great Palais de Justice and the big art gallery. From here we went to the Chamber of the senate and lower house. It was all very interesting. I tried to annex some of

Continued on Page 5

the state stationery but they spied me and said no.

"Next came the big state monument and the cathedral. Then the Hotel de Ville, and then the world-famous 'Mantien Plis', where a whole block makes its living selling souve-

nirs and cards of this one peculiar piece of art.

"We went back and arranged for our room and bought a drink in the place where they gave us such a reception the night before and they came back strong. So strong in fact, that when they smelled us enter our hotel they said we had been playing next door.

"That night we took in more sights and came home at 12. While sipping beer with the entertainers two Canadian officers came in. They were very pleasant and the girls helped things along. The captain said: 'I say won't you have something a bit more cheerful. It must take an awful lot of that stuff to get on any kind of a drunk!' So everyone took cognac. And we retired before they paid for it. We knew that it cost 3f per glass.

"We pulled out at 7 A. M. for Mons, 130f for the ticket, and my oh, what a crowd on all trains up here. Soldiers don't pay on the Brussels street cars.

"The canals were very busy this morning. Seems odd to see one person dragging a huge canal boat. But they move it.

"Factories were everywhere along the line even where there were no villages. One big brewery made a beer branded after the 'Manikin'. Most all of the factories have been sacked, and British troops are living in them.

"At Mons we breakfasted, 2 eggs, bread and butter and coffee, 3fs. This place is full of British and is only hit in two places.

"We were up in the great old tower and watched the chimneys strike 12. It was a very novel sight. Odd that the Boche did not take these bells. As they did almost all of the other church bells.

"Our dinner cost us only 6 fs, when they found we were Americans. English would have paid 9. We find that they are not loved anywhere. At 2 P. M. we got in the Express baggage coach and began to see the land of strife. Some Amzacs with us pointed out the places to us. It was very interesting and fairly fresh. As it was here that the Huns retreated, in October, it got very exciting when we crossed the Hindenburg line. The villages' completely destroyed till there was not even a wall in a whole village. We had been told that St. Quentin was fairly intact. We arrived at 6:30 P. M. and here Bill dropped off and joined us.

"Well if that city of perhaps 150,000 is not a complete wreck it is because high explosives cannot destroy.

"Even the depot looked terribly forlorn. A jackie was strolling around and told us we might find a flop at their place. The only intact house in the city. We went there and found it was our friends from Lille, who had just arrived to assist the A. R. C. A job they have been doing since we

entered the war. So you see being in the navy does not necessarily spell ocean.

"They were on very short ration and were very good to give us some place to sleep. In fact it was better than we could have given them in our own camp.

"We sallied forth in the dark looking for a cafe where we might eat. As they told us there were a few.

"It surely looked ghostly, here and there a light showed through the re-inforced paper windows. At last we followed a noise and found a cafe of one room, jammed full of drinking French soldiers. I ordered some coffee and drank it standing up. And do you know they only charged us 1f for the 4 cups.

"Across the street we saw a little store and a cafe in the adjoining room. We had our bread and they had plenty of eggs. So we ate and it was only 2 1-2 fs each.

"Then we started in the dark to see what was up and moving about. Poked around with our lights, and saw a few things of interest. In the morning the jackies fed us beans and jam and coffee. And we had target shoot in the yard with a French gun. There being countless shells everywhere.

"We started out over the wrecked canal and up the street towards the Hindenburg lines. Lord what a sight, and people moving in to those wrecks every day.

"We soon were marveling at shells unexploded and trenches and deep dark caverns, wonders for dryness and freedom from bad air. It was so fascinating that we found ourselves lingering too long.

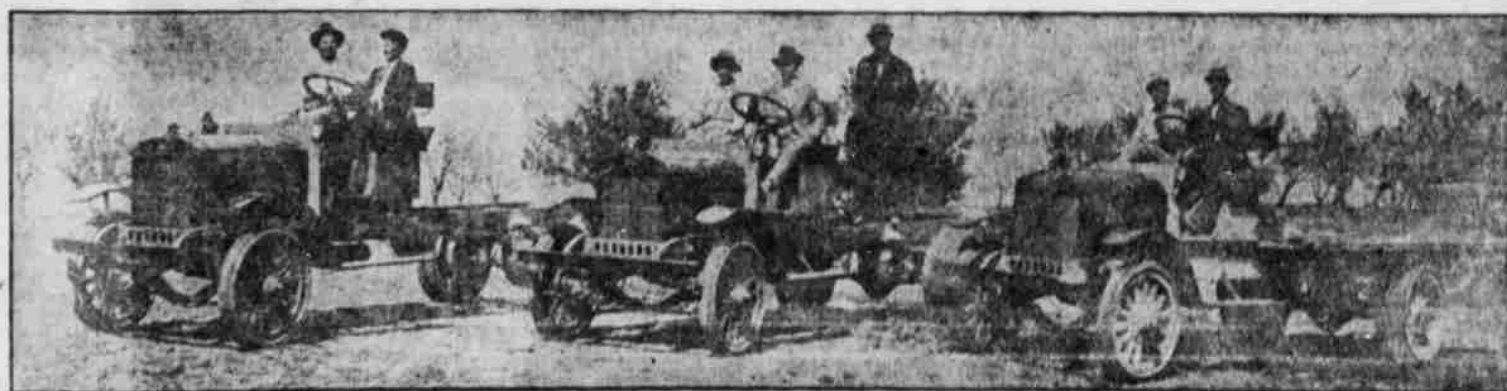
"We crossed the track and saw the swamp a good half mile wide and full of barbed wire. The waters from the broken canal made it a frightful place.

"We found a Frenchman and his family in a cellar of their former home getting ready to resume their life in that brick yard. Ever see a brick yard with the piles of culls lying around? Well that is the best description that I know of.

"We went on to the pill boxes and the concrete trenches and bomb proofs, found a whole complete water supply system, and well in one dug-out. And wine bottles everywhere. We found a lot of boxes and I brought out the ever present pliers and open them up. It was a stock of land grenades. We had never seen these kind and do not know how to explode them. So I put a wire to one and told Bill to pull and I'd try to fix it up. I put it under a plank in a trench and pulled the pin and holler-ed to him to yank the wire. But I found out it was not necessary as it began to 'smoke as soon as I released

(Continued on Page 5)

GARY MOTOR TRUCKS WIN IN ROAD WORK COMPETITION



GARY 3½ TON TRUCKS

Three Gary 3½-ton Trucks, purchased by Kay County, Oklahoma, for public road work—after a competitive test with five other leading makes of trucks.

We now have twenty trucks on the way like those shown above, all equipped with 3½ yard steel lined bodies, with Hydraulic Hoist, that we are bringing in for road construction work. These will be sold under the factory's absolute guarantee for the full period of one year.

GARY steel products lead the world. GARY Trucks are in the same class. Don't chance an unknown quality.

REPORT OF W. C. NORRIS CO.

Here is the report of the W. C. Norris Motor Sales Company, of Tulsa, Oklahoma, on the three trucks shown above, and covering their experience with motor trucks in general and GARY Trucks in particular.

"We have just closed the deal with the County Commissioners of Kay County for three GARY 3½-ton trucks. We competed with five other makes, and outpulled them all. The performance of the trucks was frankly state is marvelous. The 'H' and 'HU' 2 and 2½-ton models with four speed transmission, outpull, overpower and outclass everything in their rated capacity; while the 3½-ton is even greater in pulling power and load carrying capacity. We consider your worm drive, semi-floating Sheldon Axle as the only safe and sure form of construction for hard usage and to withstand the strain and abuse to which a truck is subjected in the oil fields and kindred lines of work. Our observation, experience and knowledge of actual results in meeting oil field requirements, with heavy loads and no-roads, convinces us that GARY TRUCKS can be relied upon in every instance and will deliver a long life of service at a nominal upkeep and low cost of operation. We are for the GARY TRUCKS strong and shall concentrate our future efforts exclusively on the GARY line.

R. C. NORRIS MOTOR SALES CO.,

(Signed) N. D. Southerland, Gen. Mgr.

Note: The W. C. Norris Motor Sales Company are a million dollar concern, and one of the largest in Oklahoma. After several years' experience with other lines of trucks, they have dropped them all and rely exclusively on GARY Trucks for heavy duty oil field work and for all purpose usage.

There is a Gary Truck for every purpose, one to five-ton sizes. All of the highest quality of design and construction. Certainty of Service is our slogan, and as WEST COAST FACTORY AGENCY we shall always be prepared to supply any duplicate part that may be required, and do any repair or service work necessary.

Pacific Highway Garage, Inc.

Clackamas County Agents

Oregon City,

Gary Coast Agency Inc.

Oregon

71 roadway

Portland, Oregon

Phone Brdwy 2162